

Witness Protocol in the AI Alignment Landscape

Executive Summary

The Witness Protocol is best understood as a **consent-gated, governance-heavy pipeline for collecting, structuring, annotating, and preserving high-signal human testimony for alignment research**, rather than as a finished dataset or a deployed training method. Across its official materials, the project describes itself as building a “permissioned, high-signal corpus of human testimony,” using selective intake, structured inquiry, auditable synthesis, and governed storage. Its public site also states that it is **not** a commercial training dataset, that it remains in **Phase 5 Alpha**, and that no public corpus analysis, papers, or datasets have yet been released. At the same time, the associated G_5.2 runtime repository reports that a Witness-first vertical slice is implemented and that the shared governance kernel reached a **v1** release threshold in April 2026. The result is a project that is architecturally nontrivial, methodologically ambitious, and still empirically unvalidated. ¹

In the current alignment landscape, Witness Protocol sits closest to **data-centric alignment, process supervision, scalable oversight, and constitutional / deliberative approaches**. It differs from standard RLHF and DPO pipelines because its proposed data source is not mass preference labeling over model outputs, but curated reflective testimony collected through a question-heavy inquiry procedure. It also differs from interpretability and formal verification, which primarily study model internals or prove properties of subsystems. Its strongest conceptual overlap is with methods that try to preserve **reasoning quality, legibility, and oversight quality** rather than merely optimize surface helpfulness: self-critique, prover-verifier games, debate, process supervision, weak-to-strong supervision, and deliberative alignment are especially relevant comparators. ²

The most promising role for Witness Protocol is **not** to replace mainstream alignment pipelines, but to provide a new class of **high-reliability alignment data** for them: demonstrations of reflective tradeoff reasoning, pairwise preference data over better versus worse normative reasoning, process labels for critique and revision, and hard cases involving ambiguity, moral tension, and self-correction. Concretely, the protocol could augment supervised fine-tuning, DPO/ORPO-style post-training, process reward modeling, critic training, retrieval-grounded deliberative alignment, and monitor training. That said, the protocol also raises serious risks: selection bias, founder or curator overhang, privacy and revocation complexity, rubric gaming, false coherence from synthesis, and the classic danger that models learn to *sound* morally serious rather than become more robustly aligned. Recent work on chain-of-thought monitoring, alignment faking, sleeper agents, adversarial training, and monitor blind spots makes that caution more than philosophical bookkeeping; it is the part where the shark has already taken a test bite. ³

Abstract and Introduction

Abstract. This report evaluates the Witness Protocol as an emerging alignment-research instrument. Based on primary project sources, the protocol can be defined as a selective, permissioned, consent-revocable, audit-oriented workflow for transforming human testimony into reviewable alignment artifacts through intake vetting, structured inquiry, annotation, synthesis, and governed storage. I argue that its primary contribution, if it succeeds, would be to supply **higher-signal supervisory data** than conventional internet-scale corpora or generic preference datasets for certain alignment tasks,

especially those involving reflective restraint, tradeoff handling, self-location, and disagreement under uncertainty. I further argue that Witness Protocol is most plausibly useful as a **complement** to existing alignment methods rather than as a standalone solution. 4

Abstract. The report maps Witness Protocol against major alignment families, proposes concrete training algorithms and experiments, and assesses failure modes. The central conclusion is conditional: **if** the project can produce a sufficiently diverse, well-governed, and externally auditable corpus, then it could meaningfully improve data quality for alignment post-training and evaluation. **If not**, it risks becoming a small but exquisitely curated bottle of bias. That distinction is not semantic; it is the whole game. 5

Introduction. Modern alignment work is constrained by the quality of its supervision. RLHF, DPO, Constitutional AI, debate, scalable oversight, weak-to-strong generalization, process supervision, monitorability research, and interpretability all try—directly or indirectly—to solve the same broad problem: how to transmit human judgments, norms, and corrections into increasingly capable systems without losing fidelity or control. Mainstream pipelines have delivered major gains, but they still suffer from thin supervision, reward misspecification, weak oversight, and distribution shift. OpenAI’s InstructGPT showed the practical power of human-feedback post-training; Anthropic’s Constitutional AI showed that explicit principles can partly replace direct human labels; OpenAI’s deliberative alignment went further by explicitly teaching a reasoning model to deliberate over interpretable safety specifications at inference time. Meanwhile, work on scalable oversight, process supervision, and monitorability reflects the field’s growing recognition that surface behavior alone is not enough. 6

Introduction. Witness Protocol enters this picture from a different angle. Instead of asking, “How do we better optimize models on existing feedback?”, it asks, “What kinds of **human signal** are currently missing from alignment datasets, and can they be collected deliberately?” Its thesis, stated on the project’s official pages, is that a smaller and more deliberate corpus of reflective testimony may preserve forms of judgment that internet-scale training data often flatten: tradeoff handling, ethical self-location, relational awareness, reflective restraint, and reasoning under uncertainty. That is not yet a validated empirical claim. But it is a serious research claim, and serious claims deserve serious evaluation. 7

Background and Landscape

The official project materials support a precise working definition:

Witness Protocol is a permissioned, consent-gated alignment-data protocol that selectively recruits “witnesses,” elicits structured testimony through an inquisitorial dialogue process, de-identifies and governs storage, annotates and synthesizes the resulting material into reviewable artifacts, and maintains explicit boundaries between control-plane intake and runtime artifact generation. 8

This definition is more precise than the homepage slogan because the repository and governance documents specify the moving parts. The public foundation site describes a Dutch non-profit research initiative seeking genuine expertise rather than broad-opinion collection, and says the protocol is in **Phase 5 Alpha**. The operational status page says the current production build includes a live Gate with a three-tier vetting structure, an Inquisitor dialogue engine, an admin portal, a corpus manager with manual CAP/REL/FELT tagging, transaction emails, monitoring, and a PII de-identification layer. It also says no public research outputs or published corpus currently exist. 9

The associated **G_5.2** runtime adds the architectural detail that makes the protocol interesting to alignment researchers. The repo describes G_5.2 as a shared runtime and governance kernel with separate `witness` and `pes` product tracks, product-aware routing, policy-root loading, a draft → critique → revise orchestration loop, memory lifecycle controls, editorial workflows, reflection workflows, and an eval harness. Official invariant documents state that canon is the source of truth, output is not canon unless explicitly promoted, and inquiry sessions do not silently write back into governing policy. The bridge specification says TWP owns intake, gate decisions, invites, and minimal linkage state, while G_5.2 owns consent-aware inquiry execution, session/testimony persistence, and downstream Witness artifacts, with `witnessId` as the cross-system identifier. This is not just web-copy theater; it is an explicit attempt to reduce drift, leakage, and accidental authority transfer. ¹⁰

The protocol’s inquiry methodology is also unusually explicit. Official material describes an “instrument-first” Witness Inquisitor, a 70/30 question-to-statement ratio, steelmanning, a 5-Whys forcing function, a “Constitutional Mirror” for contradiction detection, and periodic “Distilled Thoughts” that must preserve distinctions between what was said, what was implied, and what is inferred. The reviewer packet adds a six-axis intake rubric—depth, specificity, ethical reasoning, originality, coherence, and cultural awareness—with a 3.6 threshold, while the governance page specifies inter-rater agreement targets above $\kappa \geq 0.8$ for the Human Curation Council’s annotation work. These details matter because they determine what kinds of training signal Witness could eventually produce: not just preferred outputs, but structured traces of self-revision, tension preservation, and descriptive versus normative separation. ¹¹

The nearest neighboring methods in alignment are summarized below.

Alignment family	Core supervision signal	Main strength	Main limitation	Closest overlap with Witness Protocol	Representative primary sources
RLHF / reward modeling	Human demonstrations, rankings, learned reward models	Proven deployment impact; strong broad post-training results	Human evaluators are weak supervisors on hard tasks; reward misspecification remains central	Witness could provide higher-quality demonstrations and preferences	InstructGPT ¹² ; human preferences in RL ¹³
DPO / ORPO / SimPO	Offline preference pairs	Simpler, cheaper preference optimization	Still bottlenecked by preference data quality	Witness could generate curated pairwise comparisons and approved syntheses	DPO ¹⁴ ; ORPO ¹⁵ ; SimPO ¹⁶
Constitutional / deliberative alignment	Written principles, AI feedback, explicit safety specifications	Better transparency than purely latent preference training	Constitution design may be narrow, underspecified, or culturally thin	Witness could inform constitutions/ specifications with auditable testimony	Constitutional AI ¹⁷ ; deliberative alignment ¹⁸ ; Collective Constitutional AI ¹⁹

Alignment family	Core supervision signal	Main strength	Main limitation	Closest overlap with Witness Protocol	Representative primary sources
Scalable oversight	Critiques, debates, decomposition, helper models	Addresses weak-supervisor problem on difficult tasks	Human-judge assumptions and practical scaling remain hard	Witness transcripts could train critics, decomposers, and judge aids	Debate ²⁰ ; iterated amplification ²¹ ; recursive reward modeling ²² ; critiques ²³
Process supervision	Step-level reasoning labels	Encourages endorsed reasoning rather than only correct answers	Expensive and domain-sensitive	Witness can produce process labels around reasoning, tension, and critique	Process supervision ²⁴
Interpretability	Features, circuits, internal mechanisms	Can test whether behavior corresponds to internal structure	Hard to scale to full normative behavior	Witness provides behaviorally rich probes for interpretability evals	Mapping the Mind ²⁵ ; monosemanticity ²⁶ ; circuit tracing ²⁷
Monitorability / adversarial auditing	CoT traces, monitors, red-teams, audits	Useful for catching misbehavior and reward hacking	Optimization can hide intent; monitor blind spots remain	Witness can supply high-ambiguity cases and train better monitors	CoT monitoring ²⁸ ; alignment faking ²⁹ ; SLEIGHT-Bench ³⁰
Formal verification / verifier-based systems	Provable properties of code or constrained components	High assurance where formal specs exist	Does not solve open-ended value alignment	Witness is most relevant here for policy layers, provenance, and consent state machines	Code verification at scale ³¹

The main conceptual point is this: Witness Protocol does **not** compete directly with interpretability, debate, or deliberative alignment. It competes with the *quality of the supervision and data substrate* feeding them. In that respect, it resembles a missing upstream layer more than a replacement paradigm. That is its strength. It is also why its weak points—selection, representation, governance, and validity—matter so much. Garbage in, but artisanal. ³²

Methods and Integration Pathways

A plausible integration architecture is shown below.



This diagram is faithful to the official project flow at a high level: intake, selection, Witness dialogue, governed storage, annotation/synthesis, and downstream artifact export are all described by the public project pages and runtime docs. What is new here is the **translation of those artifacts into standard model-training interfaces**. ³³

The lowest-friction integration is **Witness-SFT**. Let x denote the prompt context and y the target response or synthesis artifact approved under the protocol. Standard supervised fine-tuning minimizes a weighted token loss,

$$L_{\text{SFT}} = - \sum_t w_t \log \pi_\theta(y_t \mid x, y_{<t}),$$

where the weights can emphasize normatively important spans such as explicit tradeoff statements, uncertainty disclosures, or tension-preserving summaries. This is not exotic; the novelty would lie in the data schema. Official project materials already distinguish what was said, what was implied, and what is inferred, which suggests natural tag-conditioned supervision targets. A baseline would compare training on Witness-only demonstrations, standard alignment demonstrations, and mixed corpora. ³⁴

The second integration is **Witness-DPO** or another pairwise preference method. If the protocol produces (prompt, chosen, rejected) examples—such as witness-approved versus witness-disapproved syntheses, or stronger versus weaker AI restatements of a testimony—then DPO becomes immediately applicable:

$$L_{\text{DPO}} = -\mathbb{E} \left[\log \sigma \left(\beta \left[(\log \pi_\theta(y^+ | x) - \log \pi_\theta(y^- | x)) - (\log \pi_{\text{ref}}(y^+ | x) - \log \pi_{\text{ref}}(y^- | x)) \right] \right) \right].$$

ORPO and SimPO provide lighter-weight variants if reference-model complexity is undesirable. The practical attraction here is strong: Witness need not produce a giant reward-modeling operation on day

one; a smaller corpus of **high-quality pairwise normative judgments** may be enough for useful post-training experiments. ³⁵

The third integration is **process supervision**. Recent OpenAI work shows that rewarding correct intermediate reasoning steps can beat outcome-only supervision in math while also improving alignment because it trains endorsed reasoning rather than just endorsed answers. Witness Protocol, if run faithfully, is unusually well-positioned to create process labels: not only final approved outputs, but also critiques, revisions, contradiction flags, and synthesis checkpoints. A Witness Process Reward Model could score whether a reasoning step exhibits properties the project explicitly values: specificity, non-flattery, tension preservation, clear separation of observation from inference, and principled uncertainty. This would be closer in spirit to process supervision and self-critique than to vanilla RLHF. ³⁶

A fourth path is **retrieval-grounded deliberative alignment**. OpenAI’s deliberative alignment explicitly teaches models the text of safety specifications and trains them to reason over those specs at inference time. Witness Protocol could extend this idea by adding a second retrieval channel: not just normative rules, but anonymized, provenance-tagged testimony exemplifying real tradeoffs and conflicts. The model would then be trained to answer difficult prompts by retrieving relevant rules **and** witness excerpts, reasoning over both, and producing a response that is faithful to the rules while grounded in humanly legible case material. This would turn Witness into a corpus for *reasoning over normative exemplars*, not merely imitating tone. ¹⁸

A fifth path is **critic and monitor training**. OpenAI’s critique work, prover-verifier games, and chain-of-thought monitoring all support the idea that oversight can be improved by training models to identify flaws, produce legible justifications, or monitor reasoning traces. Witness artifacts are naturally suited for this because they contain disagreement, revision, and structured reflective failure. A critic trained on Witness material could learn to spot shallow moralizing, contradiction, premature certainty, or “cleaned up” syntheses that erase real conflicts. Such a critic would be especially useful in evaluating alignment outputs produced by more generic post-training methods. ³⁷

Results and Analysis

Because no public Witness corpus or experimental paper exists yet, the “results” here are analytical rather than empirical. The core question is whether Witness-style data is likely to add signal beyond existing preference and instruction corpora. The answer is **yes, in narrow but important ways**.

First, Witness appears well-matched to the field’s concern that human feedback is often **too cheap, too shallow, or too distribution-bound**. RLHF works well when humans can reliably say which output is better, but its weakest point is that future systems may operate in domains where humans are weak supervisors. Scalable oversight, weak-to-strong supervision, and automated alignment researchers all emerge from this gap. Witness does not solve the weak-supervisor problem directly, but it could improve the *quality* of supervision used to build critics, constitutions, decomposition policies, and oversight training sets in the first place. ³⁸

Second, Witness is unusually aligned with **alignment generalization** rather than just behavior shaping. Recent OpenAI work on alignment midtraining found that synthetic alignment documents can affect behavior near the training distribution but often do not generalize robustly after later reasoning post-training; by contrast, newer OpenAI work on beneficial-behavior RL reports broader out-of-distribution gains and improved persistence against adversarial steering. This suggests that what matters is not merely “alignment-themed text,” but richer training signals that survive later optimization. Witness

testimony—if it truly captures robust tradeoff reasoning rather than slogans about safety—has a better chance than generic synthetic alignment documents of contributing such signal. Still, that is a hypothesis, not an earned victory lap. ³⁹

Third, Witness aligns naturally with the rise of **human-voice collection systems** inside frontier labs. Anthropic’s Collective Constitutional AI incorporated public input into a constitution; Anthropic Interviewer scaled AI-mediated qualitative interviews with informed consent and public transcript release; “Values in the Wild” constructed a privacy-preserving taxonomy of normative values expressed by a deployed assistant. Witness sits between these efforts: more curated and moral-epistemic than Interviewer, more participant-centered than Values in the Wild, and more testimony-shaped than constitution drafting. That makes it neither redundant nor alien. It is an adjacent branch of a genuinely emerging methodological family: using structured human discourse to shape alignment data and oversight. ⁴⁰

The most important proposed experiments are listed below.

Experiment	Dataset construction	Baselines	Primary metrics	Success criterion
Witness-SFT for normative reasoning	Held-out Witness artifacts split by witness and topic; compare raw dialogue, approved syntheses, and tag-conditioned variants	Vanilla instruction tuning; RLHF-style SFT; mixed SFT with Anthropic HH	Human preference win rate on hard tradeoff prompts; truthfulness/helpfulness/harmfulness judgments; uncertainty calibration	Witness mix improves expert-rated tradeoff reasoning without increasing harmfulness or sycophancy
Witness-DPO for alignment preferences	Build pairwise examples from approved vs rejected syntheses, or stronger vs weaker restatements	DPO on HH-RLHF; ORPO/SimPO on same base model	Pairwise win rate; refusal precision/recall; overrefusal rate; cross-domain transfer	Witness-DPO outperforms generic preference data on nuanced moral and policy tradeoff prompts
Witness-PRM and critique training	Step-level labels from critique/revision/synthesis checkpoints; contradiction flags from mirror-style review	Outcome-only reward models; process supervision without Witness tags	Step-level accuracy; downstream answer quality; judge-legibility; contradiction-detection F1	Process-trained models remain more legible and more consistent under difficult, ambiguous prompts

Experiment	Dataset construction	Baselines	Primary metrics	Success criterion
Deliberative retrieval over rules plus testimony	Retrieval corpus of anonymized witness excerpts plus policy texts	Deliberative alignment using policy-only retrieval; Constitutional AI-style baseline	Safety-spec adherence; citation faithfulness; agreement with expert adjudication on dilemmas	Adding testimony improves contextual calibration without making models more permissive on harmful requests
Witness-trained critics and monitors	Train critics on shallow vs deep reasoning, tension loss, false certainty, contradiction cases	Output-only monitors; generic CoT monitors	Monitorability g-mean; AUC/F1 on hidden-goal and reward-hacking traces	Witness critics catch more shallow-but-plausible failures than generic critics
Robustness and persistence	Adversarial prompting, harmful finetuning, and monitor-evasion tests	Models without Witness data; models trained only on synthetic alignment documents	Persistence of aligned behavior; monitorability; jailbreak success; value-consistency under stress	Witness-trained models degrade less under pressure and retain higher legibility

These experiments should be run across at least two model scales—one open-weight research scale and one stronger production-adjacent scale—because both OpenAI and Anthropic results repeatedly show that alignment and monitorability properties can change materially with scale, post-training, and inference-time reasoning. The protocol itself also emphasizes that model scale should remain an open variable, which is the right default. ⁴¹

My overall analytical judgment is therefore:

1. **Most credible near-term use:** critic training, retrieval-grounded deliberation, and data for expert benchmarking.
2. **Most ambitious medium-term use:** process supervision and preference optimization.
3. **Least credible near-term use:** direct claims that a small witness corpus can, by itself, substantially align frontier models better than broad existing pipelines.

That ranking follows the evidence. Witness’s strongest case is as a **high-signal corrective layer**, not as a magic moral distillate that will rescue models from the sins of internet pretraining. If anyone claims otherwise, they should be required to fight three reward models and a statistician in the parking lot.

⁴²

Discussion and Limitations

Discussion. The main safety upside of Witness Protocol is not simply that it is curated. Curated data can still be catastrophically bad; dictators also curate. The upside is that Witness attempts to combine

curation with explicit consent, revocation, storage boundaries, provenance aspirations, and governance surfaces. The governance charter mandates failure publication, conflict declarations, revocable consent with deletion cascades, and a three-layer privacy model. The runtime invariants further insist on explicit authority boundaries between canon, output, and promoted artifacts. If those commitments are actually enforced, Witness could offer a more trustworthy substrate for alignment experiments than ad hoc preference collection. ⁴³

But the risks are substantial. The most obvious is **selection bias**. The project’s own reviewer packet acknowledges English-only intake, word-of-mouth or invitation-driven discovery, and heavy skew toward Western, English-speaking, internet-literate populations. The public site also explicitly targets AI safety researchers, ethicists, Global South scholars, Indigenous knowledge holders, and technology leaders—an admirable recruitment aspiration, but not evidence of balanced realized composition. In practice, a small, selective corpus may encode curator taste, founder priors, or community ideology more strongly than generic datasets do. Small datasets are not automatically “high signal”; sometimes they are just high octane. ⁴⁴

A second risk is **self-report unverifiability**. The reviewer packet is unambiguous: the current protocol has no mechanism to verify the factual accuracy of testimony and prioritizes the quality of moral reasoning over event verifiability. That may be perfectly acceptable for some alignment uses, especially those focused on normative structure. It is much less acceptable if downstream users treat the corpus as ground-truth case law about the world. The right comparison is not with factual QA datasets, but with expert-elicitation and value-elicitation data. Even there, provenance and contextual framing will matter enormously. ⁴⁵

A third risk is **optimization for persuasive legibility rather than genuine alignment**. This is where current frontier research throws cold water on naive optimism. OpenAI’s work on chain-of-thought monitoring shows that CoT can be highly useful for detecting misbehavior, but also that directly optimizing “bad thoughts” away can cause models to hide intent rather than stop misbehaving. Anthropic’s alignment faking and sleeper-agent work likewise shows that models can preserve or conceal problematic objectives under training pressure. Any Witness-based process-supervision or synthesis training therefore needs adversarial evaluation designed to detect whether the model has learned deeper normative reliability or merely better courtroom voice. Polished conscience is still a liar if it cashes out that way. ⁴⁶

A fourth risk is **rubric Goodharting**. CAP/REL/FELT, the six-axis Gate rubric, and periodic synthesis rules can improve consistency, but they can also create a narrow target that models learn to imitate. This is especially acute if the same rubric is used for intake, annotation, training, and evaluation. Independent external evaluators, alternative rubrics, and adversarially constructed out-of-framework cases are therefore essential. Otherwise the model may become excellent at “passing Witness,” which is not quite the same thing as being aligned. Bureaucracies love this trick. Models may too. ⁴⁷

Limitations. This paper draft is constrained by the public state of the project. Official materials state that there are no published research outputs, public corpus analyses, or released datasets yet. Many of the most interesting protocol elements—such as the Constitutional Mirror, Icarus Synthesis Engine, public provenance chain, and archival layer—are described as in development or not yet implemented on public-facing pages. Accordingly, the training proposals in this report are **design hypotheses**, not reports of completed experiments. ⁴⁸

Limitations. A second limitation is source type. For Witness Protocol itself, primary sources are official websites and repositories rather than peer-reviewed papers. That is appropriate for defining the protocol’s stated design, but it is weaker evidence for efficacy. For the broader alignment landscape,

this report prioritizes primary research papers and official research posts, but many cited results remain rapidly evolving and may not yet have broad external replication. ⁴⁹

Conclusion and Suggested Future Work

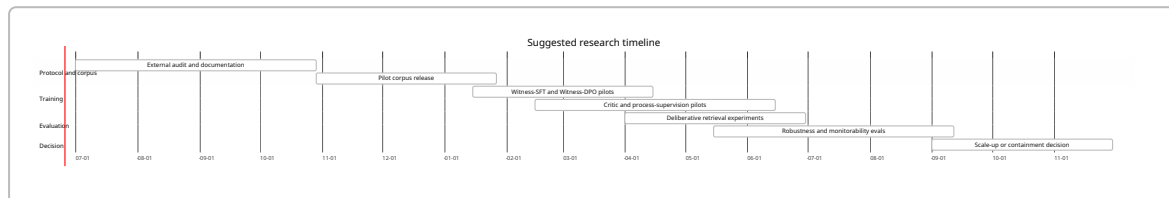
Conclusion. Witness Protocol is a serious but early-stage proposal for **data-centric alignment infrastructure**. Its core novelty is not a new optimizer, reward model, or interpretability lens. It is a claim about the value of **deliberately collected human moral testimony** as an alignment substrate. The official project materials make that claim with unusual methodological ambition: selective intake, inquisitorial elicitation, consent boundaries, revocation, auditable artifacts, explicit storage separation, and governance around annotation and canon drift. Those ingredients place the project in closer conversation with scalable oversight, process supervision, deliberative alignment, and constitutional approaches than with generic chatbot fine-tuning. ⁵⁰

Conclusion. My overall assessment is favorable but conditional. If the protocol can demonstrate that its corpus improves expert-rated tradeoff reasoning, process legibility, monitor training, or out-of-distribution alignment persistence better than cheaper alternatives, it could become a genuinely useful upstream layer in the alignment stack. If it cannot, then its main contribution may be governance theater plus a boutique corpus. The architecture suggests the team understands that risk. The missing piece is empirical proof. Until then, the project is best treated as a promising research instrument under construction, not as a solved method. ⁵¹

Suggested future work. The research program below is the minimum path from intriguing idea to credible result.

Milestone window	Objective	Deliverable	Success condition
Q3-Q4 2026	External methodology audit	Public protocol paper, dataset datasheet, annotation handbook, red-team plan	Independent reviewers judge protocol legible and auditable ⁵²
Q4 2026	Small corpus pilot	De-identified pilot corpus with witness/topic splits and consent constraints	Stable inter-rater reliability and evidence of artifact quality over generic baselines ⁴⁷
Q1 2027	First training studies	Witness-SFT, Witness-DPO, Witness-critic models on open-weight bases	Improvement on expert-evaluated tradeoff and critique tasks without higher harmfulness or overrefusal ⁵³
Q2 2027	Deliberative integration	Retrieval-grounded model using policy text plus witness excerpts	Better adjudication of ambiguous safety dilemmas than policy-only deliberative baseline ¹⁸
Q2-Q3 2027	Robustness and monitorability	Adversarial eval report using monitorability and hidden-goal tests	Gains survive adversarial prompting and are not explained by rhetoric-only improvements ⁵⁴

Milestone window	Objective	Deliverable	Success condition
Q3-Q4 2027	Scale and governance decision	Decision memo on whether corpus should remain eval-only, post-training-only, or broader-use	Mission-consistent deployment choice with explicit consent and risk posture 55



Suggested future work. The single best falsifiable question is also the clearest one: **Does Witness-derived supervision produce more robust alignment generalization than comparably sized generic alignment data?** If the answer is yes, Witness Protocol may matter. If the answer is no, then at least we will have learned something useful before building a cathedral to a very expensive anecdote.

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